COURSE

AQA A-level Business (7132)

Ratio analysis

3.7 Analysing the strategic position of a business · 3.7.2 Analysing the existing internal position: financial ratio analysis

Revision for 3.7 Analysing the strategic position of a business: each firm works it out on its own deals.

Class **AQA A-level Business (7132)** Topic **Ratio analysis**

THE LESSON

Setup	3 min
Round 1	Decisions 3 min · Deals 5 min · Topic tasks 4 min
Round 2	Decisions 3 min · Deals 5 min · Topic tasks 4 min · B2B deal 3 min
Round 3	Decisions 3 min · Deals 5 min · Topic tasks 4 min · B2B deal 3 min
Final questions	3 min

Firm decisions	**Deals**	TASK 1 **Current ratio**	TASK 2 **Raise current ratio**	
Firm decisions	**Deals**	TASK 3 **Rank current ratio**	TASK 4 **Operating margin**	**B2B deal**
Firm decisions	**Deals**	TASK 5 **High current ratio**	TASK 6 **ROCE as a %**	**B2B deal**

Fits a 30-minute lesson setting; longer settings add more deals.

Each step

Firm decisions	Each role makes its decision on its own page.
Deals	Each pupil trades with a classmate in another firm.
Topic task	The firm answers together. Everyone presses Agree.
B2B deal	One firm sells a lot of cars to another firm.
Final questions	Each pupil answers six questions.

Firm decisions

CEO	**Staff**	Hire staff. Each costs a salary and gives one benefit.
	Sabotage FROM ROUND 2	Hit a rival firm's cash, at a cost. A Legal Counsel blocks it.
Sales & Marketing	**Marketing**	Book one advert campaign to lift the next sales.
Finance	**Capital & Loans**	Borrow cash. The firm pays it back with interest.
	Investments FROM ROUND 2	Buy property or funds. The value can rise or fall.
Operations	**Seasonal stock**	Order the season's cars in advance.

B2B deal · Rounds 2 and 3

One firm sells a lot of 3 cars to another firm (4 in Round 3). With an odd number of firms, two firms offer to sell and the lower price wins.

Topic tasks

Each firm gets its own figures. The method is the same for every firm.

Task 1

ROUND 1

Can they pay their bills?

Current ratio? Type the number before ":1".

WORK OUT THE NUMBER · EXAMPLE FIGURES

Current assets	**£60,000**
Owed to suppliers	**£9,200**
Bank overdraft	**£5,800**

METHOD

Current ratio = current assets ÷ (suppliers + overdraft)

£9,200 + £5,800 = £15,000; £60,000 ÷ £15,000 = 4 : 1

Why: They hold £4 of assets for every £1 they owe soon.

Task 2

ROUND 1

Your current ratio is 0.8.

Which two actions would raise it?

PICK TWO

- ○ Buy computers on the overdraft
- ○ Pay suppliers with cash
- ✔ **Sell an unused building for cash**
- ✔ **Swap the overdraft for a 5-year loan**
- ○ Use cash to buy a new ramp

Why: Raise current assets or cut current liabilities, without the other moving.

Task 3

ROUND 2

Three dealers: current assets and current liabilities.

Order by current ratio, lowest first?

PUT THESE IN ORDER, FIRST TO LAST · RIGHT ORDER

1. **£45,000 assets, £50,000 debts**
2. **£60,000 assets, £40,000 debts**
3. **£120,000 assets, £60,000 debts**

Why: Ratios 0.9, 1.5 and 2.0.

Task 4

ROUND 2

Last year's accounts.

Operating profit margin, as a %?

WORK OUT THE NUMBER, THEN PICK IT · EXAMPLE FIGURES

Sales	**£186,000**
Cost of cars sold	**£158,100**
Overheads	**£18,600**

METHOD

Operating margin = (sales – cost of cars sold – overheads) ÷ sales × 100

£186,000 – £158,100 – £18,600 = £9,300; ÷ £186,000 = 5%

Why: Operating profit is what is left after the cars and the overheads.

Task 5

ROUND 3

Your current ratio is 3.5. Most of the current assets are cars that have not sold.

What should you do, and why?

PICK A OR B AND GIVE A REASON

- ✔ **Cut the stock you hold**
- ○ Leave it as it is

Why: Unsold stock ties up cash that could earn more elsewhere.

Task 6

ROUND 3

Last year's accounts.

ROCE, as a %?

WORK OUT THE NUMBER · EXAMPLE FIGURES

Operating profit	**£16,320**
Share capital	**£122,400**
Retained profit	**£40,800**
Non-current liabilities	**£40,800**

METHOD

ROCE = operating profit ÷ (share capital + retained profit + non-current liabilities) × 100

£122,400 + £40,800 + £40,800 = £204,000; £16,320 ÷ £204,000 × 100 = 8%

Why: Every £1 of capital employed earned 8p of operating profit.

Final questions

6
questions for each pupil

109
Level 3 Business questions

5
of them on ratio analysis

The game draws 6 of the 109 Level 3 questions; these 5 are about ratio analysis.

1 A town has many small MOT centres, customers can compare prices easily and no centre controls supply. Which market feature is most evident?
A competitive market.

2 A price-comparison platform makes dealer prices easier to observe. What competitive effect is most plausible?
Price pressure on similar dealers.

3 A campaign produces £160,000 revenue and attributable gross profit of £56,000. What is its attributable gross profit margin?
35%.

4 A dealer has current assets of £180,000 and current liabilities of £225,000. What is its current ratio, and what does it show?
0.8 to 1: short-term debts exceed the assets to meet them.

5 A finance director says the dealer is “liquid enough to get through March”. What does liquidity measure?
Whether short-term debts can be met when due.